Yibo Zhao

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PROFILE

Master of Artificial Intelligence (Research Stream) student at Monash University, with research experience in AI watermarking. My research interests include trustworthy AI, the security and safety of LLMs and AI agents, privacy protection, AI misuse detection and mitigation, and watermarking for intellectual property protection and content provenance.

- AI Security and Safety
- LLM Watermarking
- Trustworthy AI
- Machine Learning
- Deep Learning
- Agent Watermarking

EDUCATION

Mar 2025 - Dec 2026 (Expected) **Master of Artificial Intelligence (Research Stream)**
Monash University
Supervisor: Dr Asad Malik

- **Current WAM:** 82.46/100 | **GPA:** 3.73/4.00
- **Key Courses:** Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Natural Language Processing, Multiagent Systems and Collective Behaviour, Mathematical Foundations for Data Science and AI, Python Programming, Databases, IT Research and Innovation Methods, Computer Architecture and Networks
- **Master's Thesis:** Stealth-Robust Watermarking for Intellectual Property Protection of Deep Neural Networks

September 2017 - June 2021 **Bachelor of Broadcasting and Hosting Arts**
Henan University
China

PUBLICATION

Yibo Zhao, Asad Malik, Ashar Sayeed, Hanzhou Wu, and Minoru Kuribayashi. VeilMark: Stealth DNN Watermarking with Calibrated Relation Carriers. IEEE International Workshop on Information Forensics and Security (WIFS), **2026**. **Accepted**.

Yibo Zhao, Asad Malik, and Ashar Sayeed. Watermark Detection and Stealth-Robust Watermarking. **Manuscript in preparation**, **2026**.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Mar 2026 – Jun 2026 **DNN Watermarking for Model Ownership Verification**

- Under the supervision of Dr Asad Malik, took a leading role in developing the research idea and conducting the project, including method design and implementation, experimental evaluation, data analysis, and manuscript preparation, while working closely with collaborators.
- Developed VeilMark, a stealth-oriented white-box DNN watermarking method for model ownership verification. This work resulted in a first-author paper accepted at IEEE WIFS 2026. Will attend the conference in Sendai, Japan, from 7 to 11 December 2026 and present this work.

May 2026 – Present **Watermark Detection and Stealth-Robust Watermarking**

- Developing a robust, reliable, and reusable watermark detection and localization protocol based on statistical and frequency-domain analyses, together with a watermarking method designed to achieve both stealth and robustness.
- A manuscript based on this work is currently being drafted for submission.

May 2026 – Present **LLM Watermarking**

- Conducting a focused literature review on LLM watermarking, with particular interest in improving robustness while preserving semantic quality.
- Developing a research plan for subsequent experimental work on LLM watermarking.